

GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT



THEIR SOULS ARE YOURS TO PLAY WITH

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Version # 1.7

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DESIGN HISTORY



VERSION 0.90

1. Initial pass of document template
2. Deletion of irrelevant sections
3. Added high concept and rough features section

VERSION 0.95

1. Added more features
2. Added rough weapons
3. Added elements to the philosophy section

VERSION 1.00

Version 1.00 involved major content additions and re-working

1. Completely overhauled features section
2. Re-worked the weapons and abilities section
3. Added rough overview of single player
4. Added characters, controls and camera section
5. Added World overview and first world layout shots

VERSION 1.1

1. Added cover page and revised overall design
2. Minor edits to existing text

VERSION 1.2

1. Removed demon abilities and related documentation:
 - a. Madness
 - b. Hell Bound
 - c. Avatar
2. Removed caster abilities and related documentation:
 - a. Black Hole

VERSION 1.4

1. Added in-game images of characters and locations



VERSION 1.5

1. Removed zone
 - a. Catacombs; didn't enhance game enough to meet time required

VERSION 1.6

1. Removed zone
 - a. Cathedral; too graphically intensive to fit in schedule
2. Removed encounter
 - a. Jin'so boss fight; extremely difficult AI code, very buggy

VERSION 1.7

1. Added final in-game images and screenshots
2. Revised document for final hand-in
 - a. Revised all aspects of document



GAME OVERVIEW



HIGH CONCEPT

Fallen is a dark action-adventure game where the player controls a priestess, possessed by an ancient demon in a quest for revenge and power. Set within a society consumed by a corrupt religion, in-game audio driven dialogue immerses the player into the character and story. Fighting through a mystical city, the player must use the souls of enemies to overcome challenges. Souls can be used for devastating spell attacks, imbue objects with life or even to physically manifest into the demon within. Fallen is built upon the existing Unreal 2004 engine.

PHILOSOPHY

A Story That Has To Be Heard

The story of Fallen is uniquely told through audio dialogue with limited use of scripted sequences. You have been possessed by an ancient demon that guides you through the game however he is not to be associated with the typical NPC assistant, while the Demon does aid the player – he also has his own agenda. The Demon speaks and interacts with the player entirely through audio dialogue that simulates a voice in your own head. By doing this we aim to emphasize a key feature in Fallen, immersion. The player should feel like they are the main character and that this demon is a voice in their head which they must individually judge as trustworthy or not.

A Mature Game for a Mature Audience

Our target audience is the male 19-35 demographic. Our objective is to make a dark, action-story experience that appeals to our evil sides, channeling them in a more-or-less productive way. Fallen features corrupt religions, possession of souls, fireballs, meteors and demons that tear through plate armor with a single attack – this is a game for people who enjoy making things go boom... or squish.

Pick Your Poison

Fallen isn't a first person shooter nor is it a third; it's a hybrid. In caster form use your FPS skills to command a variety of spells, ranging from throwing a chakram to summoning a meteor. While in Demon Form play from a third person perspective and smash your enemies with melee attacks, using the ability to manipulate time itself to close distance with the enemy. Both are viable but it is up to the player on how they use their abilities. Advanced players may even use the abilities of both forms to complement each other, for example stopping time and casting multiple meteors instead of just one.

Who am I?

Aside from the utility of different cameras, the immersive quality also plays a large part. While you are in caster form (first person), you are the priestess. However when you switch to Demon Form, so does the camera to third person. This is to simulate you almost switching positions with the Demon, it's important to differentiate that the player is in control of Vestai, not the Demon.



COMMON QUESTIONS

Who are Empyreal Games?

Empyreal Games is a company formed from students of the VFS Game Design Program (GD07) to create a game as a final project which is eventually showcased to industry professionals. Empyreal Games consists of: Alberto Mejia, Azlan Mustapha, Brock Robin, Erik Shultz and Steve Shea.

Where does the game take place?

Fallen is set within Aastille, a magnificent ancient city inhabited by people whom magic is second nature to. The people are separated into classes from the lower to the upper bourgeois class who live at the higher stages of the tiered city. Above the crest of the city floats the Cathedral, a symbol of divinity that overshadows all of the citizens below it.

Who do I control?

You play as Vestai, a young priestess of the Order who has been possessed by Azrael, an ancient demon with his own intentions. You are able to play as either Vestai or the Demon Azrael whom resides within Vestai's soul (for limited periods of time)

What's the main focus?

Fallen has a dark story, the player isn't ever entirely sure of what's going on behind the curtains of the Order or what the true motives of Azrael are. What the player does know is survival; fighting through a city turned against you, using massive spells against numerous enemies while uncovering the mystery of an ancient conflict between demons and angels that you're now in the middle of. That is the focus of Fallen.

What's different?

Fallen's approach on the defined action-adventure game is to take not only the gameplay in new directions but also the story. The story is dark and clouded, possessed by a demon who isn't necessarily your ally is a break from the traditional companion that guides the player for the player's good. Furthermore, by utilizing both first and third person gameplay, Fallen comfortably bridges the gaps between FPS – TPS; magic – melee, and offers new play styles by allowing the player to use both to enhance the other. After all, what good is summoning a meteor if you can't slow time to enjoy the view.

Some may criticize that Fallen is part of an already defined and saturated genre. However simply because the genre has standards doesn't make the games within it repetitive of each other, one must only look at games like God of War to see that individuality and quality are still uniquely achievable – even in hack n' slash type games.

Recent games such as "The Darkness" and "Infernal" incorporate elements of the 'evil NPC', we've explored these games and tried to improve on weak areas as well as taking elements of what work within those games.



FEATURE SET



A HYBRID 1ST/3RD PERSON, ACTION/ADVENTURE

Fallen is a hybrid game; combining elements from first and third person games that work best with our game mechanics in order to provide the player with a new gameplay experience.

- **1st Person – Caster form and Immersion**

Caster form is the default player form and enables the player to cast an array of spells at the cost of souls. When in caster form a first person camera is used. This is for several reasons.

- Immersion

The player is drawn into every aspect of the game, as if you are viewing the world with your own eyes, firing spells with your own hand, exploring with your own feet and most importantly; hearing the demon in your own head. Immersion is one of Fallen's primary features and is best obtained through a first person camera. The visible weapon is the caster's hand which is stretched forward before the camera in a semi-realistic manner.

- FPS Familiarity

Caster form utilizes the same ingredients as a typical FPS, using different ranged attacks in trade for a resource (in our case souls). Because this is the most typical camera for such gameplay, players already familiar with FPS controls/gameplay don't have to learn new skills in order to skillfully play.

- Accuracy

When you cast spells it is important that whether they land where you desire or not is a question of player skill, not of camera angle. Because spells cost resources it is imperative that the player never wastes resources due to frustrating camera angles. Some spells have arcing projectiles; for example 'Chakram' will only hit the crosshair at short-medium range, at longer ranges the player must take gravity into account.



- **3rd Person – Demon Form and Disconnection**

Demon form enables the player to turn into the demon within, sacrificing ranged power for a more resilient defense, unstoppable melee attacks and control over time. When the player changes to Demon form the camera switches to a third person view.

- Field of view

Demon form is typically activated in panic situations for the caster, this typically involves many enemies. By switching to third person, the player can see a larger field of view and not feel overwhelmed by large groups of enemies. This also allows the player to properly judge the scale of their attacks and easily maneuver if surrounded.

- Cinematic Gameplay

The demon towers over enemies and decimates them with his claws, he is intimidating and brings an element of style with the ease at which he can combat enemies. This is also matched in his animations which are visually satisfying and illustrate the power of the Demon, by using a 3rd person camera it is possible to illustrate a full body of movement, rather than one or two hands blazing across the screen. Furthermore, with abilities such as slow/stop time, it is satisfying to watch the Demon dodge around slow projectiles or body slam a group of enemies into oblivion which couldn't be as appealing in first person.

- Disconnecting the player

When you are in caster form you are also in the immersive first person mode, this is to give the impression that you, the player, are in control of Vestai – the priestess. When you switch to Demon Form it's important to visually separate both the caster and the Demon so that it is clear that the Demon is NOT the same as the caster. This is important for both story and overall gameplay. It also helps lend that imposing feel to the situation as the demon is roughly 1.5x the size of his opponents.

- **Action with a bit more thought**

Throughout the level there are many enemies on screen at once presenting an intimidating opposition for the player. The average enemy soldier is fairly weak on its own however through numbers and diversity they become more powerful. For example, the enemy priests are able to heal their comrades, forcing the player to have to prioritize targets, or figure out creative ways to kill opponents.

- **Adventure - in your mind and in the game – a mature experience***

In Fallen, the player psychological experience is taken with heavy consideration. We want the player to be intrigued, interested and at times almost scared by what is going on and by what is being told to them. For these reasons we believe that it creeps into the horror-adventure genre, as ultimately you are a victim to the manipulation of the demon and the society around you, yet you are powerless without the demon's power. The story presented to the player and the dialogue lends itself more towards a dark mature theme. Though it is a tale of heaven, hell, angels and demons, it is not as cookie cutter as good vs. bad. Each side is blurred and twisted in a story shrouded in mystery that the player can only hope to discover by 'tagging' along

**We would like to explore this design more thoroughly in a future version of Fallen*



SOULS AS A RESOURCE

Fallen employs a universal ammo system in the form of souls, similar to a mana pool. The difference with Fallen and the traditional mana pool is that it is based upon your ability to kill your enemies. Rather than relying on frustrating regeneration or consumables, the player gains the souls of vanquished enemies which are then used to power more attacks. As a result the player has to be efficient and intelligently choose when to use more powerful spells against different groups of enemies.

Every time you kill someone their soul is drawn into your body, adding to your 'soul pool'. In dire situations the player is able to fall back onto their Chakram ability which has no soul cost, this is critical to prevent the player from ever having no souls and therefore no way to power attacks to gain souls.

The Choice Is Yours

It is up to the player whether they want to continually use their souls on minor spells or if they want to save up for the more devastating abilities. Using moderately powerful spells might provide reliable, consistent damage and soul income but saving up for the 'uber' attacks allows the player to risk many souls on a single attack. If that one attack succeeds in killing many enemies – it will be more efficient than having cast several lighter spells. It's this risk vs. reward that brings player's own styles to the game.

Occasionally some of the souls you've absorbed will talk to you and reveal plot points. On one hand you will have the demon in your head that is trying to tell you what to do, but you will also have conflicting information from the souls you are absorbing.

THREE UNIQUE WAYS TO WREAK HAVOC

Fallen provides three unique schools of spells and abilities for the player to obliterate enemies. When designing the abilities of Fallen we kept 3 pillars in mind for our spells that would provide guidance on what a spell should do and how it should do it; they are detailed here:

- **Variety** – Spells shouldn't duplicate each other and should encourage using other abilities to complement it
- **Combinations** – Giving the player added bonuses for using two spells together (explained further on)
- **Catering to Play style** – Give the player enough ability within a single school to rely on it, maybe you prefer melee, spell casting or having others do the work for you. However using all three play styles offers the greatest rewards as some abilities are simply more effective in different situations

The three schools themselves are designed to play differently, offering different and distinct advantages and disadvantages.

****For detailed spell/ability listings please see "Spells and Abilities" section**



Caster Form – Take them out from afar

Versatility and Variety

Caster-based game play will be an experience most similar to other first person shooter games in that you will be aiming your spells as if they were weapons. Spell casting can be referenced to games such as Elder Scrolls: Oblivion which incorporates a first person view with spells.

Players are given a variety of spell-types within caster form:

- **Direct Damage** (eg. Fireball)
- **Damage over time** (aka DoT eg. Blood Boil)
- **Status Effects** (eg. Life drain)
- **Area of effect** (aka AoE eg. Blastwave)

It is important that the player has a range of spell styles to use within caster form due to the situational encounters faced. In some circumstances the player will be surrounded by enemies, in which case Blastwave would be the best choice of spell, each spell has a specific purpose and use. Furthermore, some spells can be combined with others to make them more powerful, this will be explained further on.

Soul Cost

All of the spells in caster form will have a soul cost with the exception of Chakram. Most of your spells will have a low to moderate soul cost, but your ultimate abilities will have an intense price associated with them.

Physical Form

In trade for the caster's damage potential at range is a weakness to physical attacks such as a soldier's sword. Physical attacks cut through the caster's armor easily however magic attacks do less damage compared to when in Demon Form. This forces the player to be mindful not only of their attack but also their defense and adds elements of strategy.

Demon Form – Unstoppable Force... at a price

Rip people to shreds

Demon form is the physical manifestation of the demon that has possessed you. Upon switching to this form Vestai will shield her eyes in first person before she transforms into the demon and into a 3rd person view. As a caster you are slightly shorter than most of your opponents, the Demon is 1.5x their size. Able to swipe groups of enemies with his mighty claw and send them flying backwards; he is a close-up juggernaut – the complete opposite of the caster.

The demon has several variations of melee, all of which will decimate lesser enemies. But perhaps the deadliest ability in the demon's arsenal is his power to manipulate the time stream, slowing down or stopping it completely. This in particular has great potential to work in conjunction with many of the caster spells as time stop/slow persists if the player switches back into caster form, allowing advanced use of ranged spells.



Soul Cost

While in Demon form the player should feel very powerful and physically imposing, almost unstoppable. However this power comes at a price. Transforming into demon form has a high soul cost, and the longer it is maintained – the more souls tick away as well as any non-melee abilities that the demon activates. This is to encourage intelligent use of the demon and to give the player a sense of urgency. Enemies killed within demon form still add souls, this adds a berserker style element where if you go on a rampage and successfully defeat many enemies you are able to stay in Demon form longer.

Physical Form

Naturally part of being a nine foot tall demon is the ability to absorb a few more 'puny' sword swings or arrow. The demon's only outstanding weakness is the holy magic at the hands of Priests. The parity between the two makes being against a group of priests a dangerous or expensive endeavor.

***Animating – Let your minions do the work**

You look the same, but you have friends

Animating is a subset of spells within caster form that allow the player to imbue objects with souls and then bring them to life. For varying soul costs, the player is able to turn statues into powerful stone golems. Once the player has brought these golems to life, they will roam the environment and decimate any enemies in their path. However this is only for a limited time period, they also have their own health – if that expires then their stone shell will crumble to the ground.

Advantages and Disadvantages

The advantage of animating golems is that the player is able to take the focus off of them and let their animated creature distract and damage the enemy. The player can sit behind his golem, watching as it destroys enemies and then cast spells from relative safety.

The disadvantage of animating objects is that it costs souls and the minion is only under the player's control for a limited time. It also means that the player is relying on other characters to do their work for them, this can be good or bad – depending on the skills of the player.

Physical Form

Animating is a spell type casted from within the caster form and cannot be used in Demon form.

***The Undead**

In future releases of Fallen, we plan to include the ability to not only animate statues, but the fallen corpses of your enemies. For little soul cost the player would be able to resurrect any enemy type – these would then behave as they normally would (priests heal, archers shoot etc.) but on the side of the player. Most importantly, they would be controllable by the player, allowing you in one case to create a wall of undead soldiers to block your enemies while you rain fireballs upon them.

*Planned for a future release of Fallen



AUDIO-DRIVEN STORY

Your head is alive with the sound of evil

Possessed by an ancient demon on a quest for revenge, the player is blind to the exact purpose and meaning behind the demon's quest – almost confused... but in a good way. Fallen's story will be delivered via in-game dialogue as opposed to the more traditional use of NIS's. Plot points and events will be unfolding on the screen and in the player's mind as the demon narrates his side of the story. Consider 'Cortana' from Halo but instead of the chirpy, helpful and insightful AI that guides the player through the game; think of the demon as a frightening, misleading and vengeful demon that guides the player through the game.

The demon also serves as a realistic way to give the player a tutorial. As the player progresses through the game, the demon will introduce the player to their powers and will grant the player newer powers as they progress through the level.

Two Sides to any good Story

Now incase it's not enough to just present one side of a story about manipulation, corruption and mystery - Occasionally when the player kills other enemies and absorbs their souls they will be treated to dialogue strings of the recently absorbed giving their perspective of the story. You will be hearing conflicting information from these fallen foes that the demon is trying to suppress. Essentially both sides will be trying to make the player understand their side of the story.

SPELL COMBOS

The spells and abilities, as well as forms in Fallen were all designed with one another in mind. As a result, using certain spells in conjunction or at the right time has bonus effects. First of all it should be distinguished that some of these combo's will appear as emergent gameplay and others are scripted (detailed below).

Scripted

Scripted spell combinations take two abilities and combine them for a more powerful result. For example the player has a skill called 'blood boil' that slowly damages an enemy over time. They cast this spell on an enemy guard, afflicting him with the DoT. Another spell, fireball, deals direct impact damage from a large molten rock. When these two spells are combined, the target will explode and boil anyone nearby, dealing extra damage.



Playing Smart

In testing our game we have discovered many methods of play that border on emergent gameplay; there are several ways in which the player can utilize spells together for added... unpredicted effects. The importance of this is that each player can bring their own creativity and skills to Fallen and resultantly have a unique experience. We aim for Fallen not to never play the same way twice, but instead for each player to have a unique style and method.

Examples of emergent combos found:

- **Life from Death** – raising a golem and then life draining it
- **Blockade** – Animate one of your giant stone golems and have him stand in front of a door before he turns back into stone, perhaps blocking a passageway where guards are coming from
- **Infernal** – Cast blood boil on a golem to give it an immolation effect
- **Peek-a-boo** – Stop time, sneak into a group of enemies, change into caster and blastwave

*SPEECH RECOGNITION

Speech recognition is a feature that already exists within Unreal. We are proposing modification so that it can be used in conjunction with plot elements. As our game is heavily focused around immersion and 'the voice in your head' it would lend itself to both elements.

Examples of how speech recognition might work are when the demon asks you to do certain things like "light those peasants on fire" you can respond with a simple "no" and he will respond unkindly. The other major element we can see this being used for is to ease the issuing of commands to your minions. Examples might be telling your zombies to "attack" or "stay" or "protect". This should be fairly simple to do considering this is essentially how it already works in Unreal. In terms of story, it was considered that the demon might ask a question to the player which would be recorded in secret and then repeated to the player later in the story for a sheer shock moment (**LEGAL ISSUE**).

Though we think it will be a potentially cool element, it is lowest on our list of features for the fact that it is extra work incorporating some of these elements into the story and not everyone has a microphone.

*Planned for a future release of Fallen



SINGLE PLAYER GAME



OVERVIEW

Fallen is an immersive and exciting single-player experience that pits you, the player, against a city ruled by a corrupt faith. Possessed by a demon soul, you can't trust it and it can't trust you – but you share the same objective, defeat the Angel Jin'so and expose the seeds of corruption lying within the city.

Using powerful magic to destroy and absorb enemy souls, animate objects with life or even manifest into the great demon within. Gameplay will flow through 2 levels filled with enemies and opportunities to uncover the mysteries of your past.

Fallen's single player game, as it is designed for VFS, will consist of only two levels to demonstrate the spells and abilities of the game. You will be fighting your way through the upper portion of the city towards a large cathedral floating above the central part of the volcanic lake on which the city is built.

THE EVIL WITHIN

During the course of the single player experience you receive audio cues from the demon that has possessed you. This is especially frequent during moments of instruction or of key importance to the story. As you progress through the game, some souls you absorb continue to communicate with you after death. These souls hint at various story elements including your past and help give the player pieces to tie together the story of the game.

A MAGICAL CITY

Fallen takes place within Aastille, a city where magic is an everyday tool. This is seen in all aspects of Fallen, especially in architecture. As the player travels across the following areas in Fallen they will see a city forged by magic that immerses the player into the world.



Figure 1: Archway



LEVEL PROGRESSION

The player will progress through several zones within the city. Primarily within the Upper City, the player will journey through a barracks, a market, a residential district and finally to the grand bridge connecting the city with the Cathedral.



Barracks

Fallen begins in the Barracks of the city where the player has been recently saved by the demon within. With the guards alerted, the player is immediately under pressure from enemies while discovering new abilities as given by the Demon. As the player fights through the Barracks, they face increasing numbers of soldiers and eventually archers. As well as unlocking new abilities for the player, the demon guides the player towards the next zones, in this case – the upper city.

Abilities unlocked:

- Chakram
- Fireball
- Life Drain

Market

The recently evacuated market is still open, with stalls and shops selling goods. It is a communal area built under a massive archway and separates the Barracks with the residential area.

Abilities unlocked:

- Blood Boil
- Blastwave



Residential Area

Once having made their way through the challenges of the market, the player will enter the residential area. It is far more open than other zones with decorative plants and paved streets for those fortunate enough to live there. Here the player will face the priest class for the first time and also features branching paths in the level. The importance of this area lies within player choice, story and varying play spaces in which to fight and use abilities.

Abilities unlocked:

- Animate
- Demon Form



The Gate

The gate is the last obstacle before the bridge leading to the cathedral, your ultimate destination. It is well fortified and the most difficult challenge for the player up to this point. This is where you learn your last spell to help you with the challenge of fighting a tough diverse group of enemies. Once you have defeated them, you will be able to open the gate barring entrance to the bridge.

Abilities unlocked:

- Meteor

The Bridge

The bridge is a major architectural feature that arcs its way up to the floating piece of earth on which the cathedral is situated. It has a brilliant view of the previously conquered areas of the map that gives a feeling of immersion and scale when the player sees from where they have progressed.

The enemies along the bridge will be sparse and offer little resistance, merely cannon fodder to lure them into a false sense of security. The real threat is the Angel Jin'so, towering above the Cathedral, he taunts and jeers at the approaching player. Once the player has crossed 50% of the bridge, the Angel will summon his wrath upon you, turning the sky into a dark clouded night, raining and thundering as you approach. In response to this, the demon within will unleash himself and the player will rush towards the cathedral at great speeds to confront his foe.

The End

Once the player reaches the ground outside the Cathedral, a massive sword falls from the sky and slams into the ground before the player. Following it is the angel, who crawls out of the massive crater using his sword as a support. He towers over even the Demon and roars out "You are doomed". It is here where the game ends, leaving the player with anticipation for the fight. Ideally the boss encounter would be playable however due to time constraints we feel it would be more satisfying to use a demo ending, leaving the player wanting more.

HOURS OF GAMEPLAY

Fallen is a student project designed within a tight schedule, as such it will only feature two levels with about 10-15 minutes of gameplay. A full length treatment of Fallen would see a longer, more drawn out story experience on the order of about 16 hours. The intention is to illustrate mechanics and effects within this play period that would be repeated in a fuller game.



CAMERA

OVERVIEW

Fallen is a hybrid FPS/TPS game. When the player is in the default 'caster form', the game is played from a first person perspective however when the player switches into 'demon form' the camera pans out into a third person perspective. Other perspectives will only be used in specific machinima sequences.

FIRST PERSON VIEW

When in 'caster form' the game is shown from a first person perspective.



Using a first person camera is specifically for 'caster form' to immerse the player into the environment and also for the usability of caster abilities.

Because all the caster's attacks are ranged, the player needs to easily aim and move. The first person perspective satisfies this best.

THIRD PERSON VIEW

When the player switches to 'demon form' the game switches from first person to third person.



Demon form uses third person for several key reasons. It is important that the player doesn't feel that they 'are' the demon, the player is the caster hence first person, in demon form they are a sort of observing although the player is still in control.

This view is also critical for the demon's play style, fast and furious. A third person camera allows the player to keep track of the surroundings whilst still fighting at a fast pace.



THE GAME WORLD



OVERVIEW

The world of Fallen takes place in the city of Aastille, a city being devoured by a sinister force masquerading as a holy religion. It is a large tiered city divided into a lower, middle, upper and cathedral area. Similar to Minas Tirith from Lord of the Rings, it is built into the side of a mountain and broken up into ringed sections.

A VISUAL FEAST

The city of Fallen will put you in awe of its grand size and arcane inner workings. The city is a beautiful scene of detailed architecture and ornate decoration; lush gardens and plants line the streets through the market and upper city. The epic bridge crossing from the city to the rising cathedral is lined with giant statues and overlooking the bridge the player can see the entire landscape that the city they were just in was built on. Fallen promises not only to offer destruction, but also beauty. Beautiful Destruction?





THE PHYSICAL WORLD

Overview

The city of Fallen is a mystical arcane city. It resembles a blend of a Greek and Roman styles which feature detailed, ornate stone architecture. With magic being such a major feature of Fallen, it is also shown within the buildings of the city. Incorporated into the very stones of their buildings are gems and crystals that resonate their energies to serve as either decorations or to even physically bind the two materials. The architecture draws inspiration from the above mentioned civilizations/times as well as Lord of the Rings and World of Warcraft (such as the blood elves/high elves).

Key Locations

As mentioned in the single player breakdown there are a few key areas of the levels.

- **Barracks** – The primary blocker for entering the Upper city, first challenges
- **Market** – Developing the story and ramping up difficulty
- **Upper City** - Diversity of choice/path as well as mixing up the encounters
- **Bridge** – The calm before the storm, allows the player to experience the environment and build up to cathedral
- **Cathedral** – Teaser ending before final boss fight



Night night...

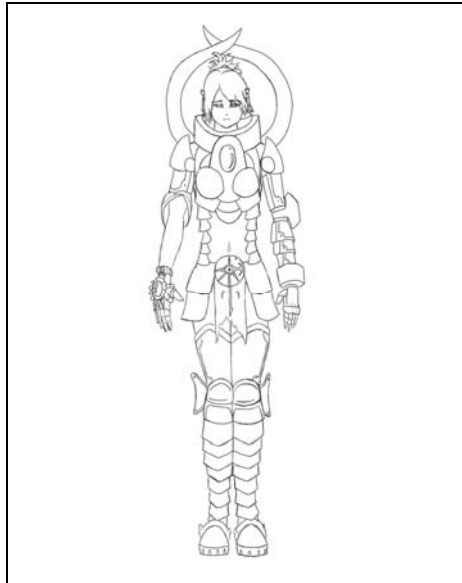
Vestai was kidnapped and saved in the night, this is when the game begins. There is a moonlit blue tone to all of the level, contrasted by warm torch lit streets with a night sky lit up by meteors. This is the contrast given by setting Fallen during the night, a major issue with setting Fallen during the day would be the monotones of color. Many spells are fire based and glow orange, as a result they stand out much better at night rather than blending in. Also it allows the excuse of the citizens being asleep so that the city isn't unrealistically dead.



GAME CHARACTERS



THE PRIESTESS, VESTAI



Vestai, once a priestess of the Order, she was victim to an attempted sacrifice and is now possessed by the demon spirit that saved her. With a city against her she turns to revenge against those who betrayed her.

Vestai is roughly 5'8 and still wears the ceremonial armor used for the sacrifices; through it she can channel her magic and use her chakram to defeat enemies.



THE DEMON, AZRAEL



Figure 2 - Demon in-game

An ancient creature, the Demon appears has been dormant within Vestai's soul since she was born, now he must act as she is being taken to be sacrificed. He saves her from death, yet curses her at the same time. Now Jin'so knows of Azrael's presence he will stop at nothing to see both Vestai and Azrael dead. If Vestai's soul power is high enough The Demon Azrael, can even become whole for a short period of time and unleash his powers.

The Demon towers at roughly 8'0 and uses his hulking claws to sweep his enemies. Capable of altering both gravity and time, he is a unique and feared being.



CITY GUARD



NPCs (Soldier, Priest, Archer)

Having disrupted the sacrifice and now a fugitive, Vestai must also face the city guard to reach her objective. Entire regiments stand on guard within the city and are called by the tolling alarm bells placed throughout the city.

SOLDIERS

The Soldier is the standard melee unit of the City Guard. Dressed in plate armor adorned with low grade arcane runes he is vulnerable to both magic and heavy attacks.

Wielding a standard issue sword, soldiers are capable of dealing great damage in melee range, especially to those in lighter armor.





PRIESTS

The Priest is a militarized unit of the Order serving within the City Guard. Priests wear especially light armor but have strong arcane runes attached to their bodies, the strongest of which are attached to their hands, converting them into ethereal limbs.

Priests wield no weapon but their magic. Capable of healing nearby allies they are strong support units. Although priests also have magical attacks, they are only effective against darker beings, such as demons.



ARCHERS

The archers of the City Guard are trained in only the use of a single weapon, the crossbow. As a result, they are deadly accurate and capable of piercing armor at great range. Their weakness however is in their armor, due to their effectiveness at range they wear only light armor and are fairly weak against all forms of attacks.

The arrows of the City Guard are fast, accurate and deadly. Amidst a battle they can pick off a single target, making it extremely hard for the victim to concentrate on the battle at hand whilst avoiding incoming arrows.





GOLEMS



A creature made purely of rock, the Golem is an ally that can be summoned by the spell animate. Golem's can only be crafted out of specific rock, luckily the rocks used to build statues of Jin'so prove quite useful for creating these Golems.





THE ANGEL, JIN'SO



Jin'so is the pinnacle of sacrificial conversion, he is the patriarch of the Order and a symbol to all. Masquerading as an avatar of peace, his true purpose is much more sinister and fuels the corruption within the Order. He towers at 20' tall and carries a great sword of unparalleled power.



SPELLS AND ABILITIES



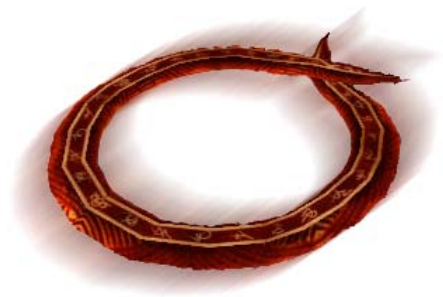
OVERVIEW

Fallen has a wide array of spells and abilities each tailored to the 'form' in which they will be used: Caster, Demon or Animating. For more information on each particular form please refer to features section.

Caster Spell / Ability Descriptions

Chakram

The chakram is the only ability in the game with no attached soul cost; it is the quintessential fallback weapon. Vestai draws her own soul energy from her halo which she can then project at her enemies. Imagine a soul frisbee...that cuts through people. It can be powered up to do more damage and reflect off surfaces but at a soul cost.



Firing Modes

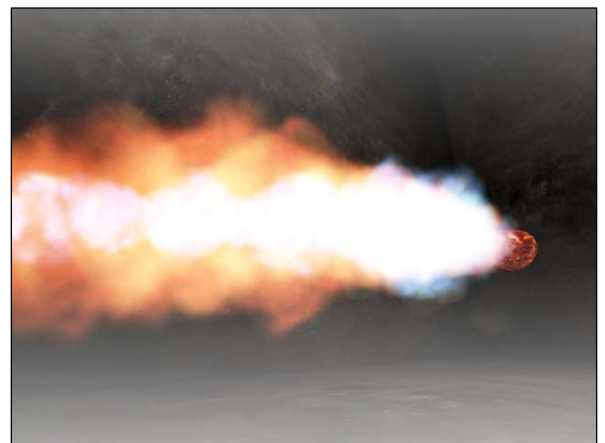
- *Left Click:* Standard throw, dissipates after hitting a person/object
- *Right Click:* Reflects off surfaces and deals extra damage

Fireball

The fireball is as the name suggests, a ball of fire. Hurling a molten rock engulfed in roaring flames is always a reliable and effective way to dispatch enemies. The alternative fire produces a larger more intense projectile that not only deals more damage but also has a much larger explosion on impact.

Firing Modes

- *Left Click:* Arcing fireball projectile
- *Right Click:* Exploding fireball projectile





Meteor



The pinnacle of the fire element; for enough souls the Priestess is capable of summoning a giant meteor from the skies above. Tearing through the atmosphere, it hurdles towards its destination and decimates anything unlucky enough to be near the explosion. This is the Priestess' most powerful spell and as a result, comes with a very high soul cost.

Firing Modes

- *Left Click:* Summon Meteor

Blastwave

Blastwave is an area of effect spell that sends any enemies near the player backwards, allowing the player to recuperate from any unfavorable situation. Best used when surrounded by enemy units in close proximity, you can let loose a ring of fire that deals light damage and knocks back opponents. Has a moderate soul cost because it is an area of effect spell.

Firing Modes

- *Left Click:* Activates blastwave

Blood Boil

Blood Boil raises the temperature of the targets blood so that they will take damage over time. It is a low soul cost/instant cast spell and can be cast on many people at a time, simultaneously dealing damage to all targets. It can also be re-cast on a target to do even more damage.

Firing Modes

- *Left Click:* Casts blood boil on a target



Life Drain

Priests are traditionally trained in healing allies; however with the corruption of the Demon spirit within, the Priestess now steals life itself from her enemies to regenerate. Life drain is a channeled spell that must be maintained on a single target to be effective.

Firing Modes

- *Left Click:* Begins channeling the Life Drain spell

Animate



With the power to control and manipulate souls; much like absorbing souls of the dead, Vestai is capable of releasing souls into objects to grant them life. The action of animating only requires one universal spell to cast. A target capable of being animated must be targeted by the player and once the spell is cast, souls are drained to give the target life.

In the current build of Fallen only statues may be animated into golems, however there are designs for the ability to animate the dead and different creatures which would be included in future releases.

Firing Modes

- *Left Click:* Releases souls into target



Demon Spell / Ability Descriptions



Demon Form

Demon form is a powerful ability that grants immense powers as well as increased resistance to physical damage. Able to decimate enemies with powerful melee attacks and manipulate the battlefield with the control of time, he can make short work of any number of foes if played right. The flipside of this is that the player takes more damage from holy attacks.

Claws / Body Slam

The Demon's primary means of destruction are his sharp, powerful claws. His primary attack is an arcing claw attack that can hit multiple enemies. His secondary attack charges forward, slamming his body into anything unfortunate enough to be in his path.

Firing Modes

- *Left Click:* Arcing Claw attacks
- *Right Click + Hold:* Body Slam



Time Stop / Slow

Much of the demons power comes from his power to manipulate the environment around him; this includes the slowing down/stopping of time. If the player stops time they are able to move around freely while everything else on the screen is frozen. Similarly, if you slow time the world around you slows down, allowing you time to dodge projectiles or carefully aim. Both abilities cost SPS (souls per second), this is to encourage skillful soul management and decisive action when using 'wow' abilities like slow/stop time.

As opposed to actually being spells that are selected and then cast, slow and stop time are abilities that can be toggled on or off when in demon form whilst any other ability is selected. It is also possible to manipulate time and then enter caster form, from which you can revert back to regular time.

- *Z: Toggle Time Stop*
- *X: Toggle Time Slow*

**The following abilities could not make it into the current release of Fallen but are planned for future builds*

Avatar

The demon can manipulate his environment by making things not what they seem. When the demon casts deception on an enemy they are suddenly rendered in his image and he becomes invisible for a very brief moment. This makes everyone swarm and attack the newly appointed demon.

Firing Modes

- *Left Click + Hold:* Channels avatar on an enemy

Madness

The demon is capable of suffocating a target in souls, forcing them to go blind with power and rage. This effect forces the unit to attack anything nearby with greater force and fury, including allies.

Firing Modes

- *Left Click:* Infuses target with souls



CONTROLS



Controls

Spells & Abilities

Movement



Time Control

SPELLS & ABILITIES:

- 1 – Chakram
- 2 – Fireball
- 3 – Blood Boil
- 4 – Life Drain
- 5 – Blastwave
- 6 – Animate
- 7 – Meteor
- TILDE ~ – Demon Form/Caster Form

TIME CONTROL:

- Z – Toggle stop time
- S – Toggle slow time

MOVEMENT:

- W – Forward
- A – Strafe left
- S – Backward
- D – Strafe right

MISCELLANEOUS

ESCAPE – Access menu



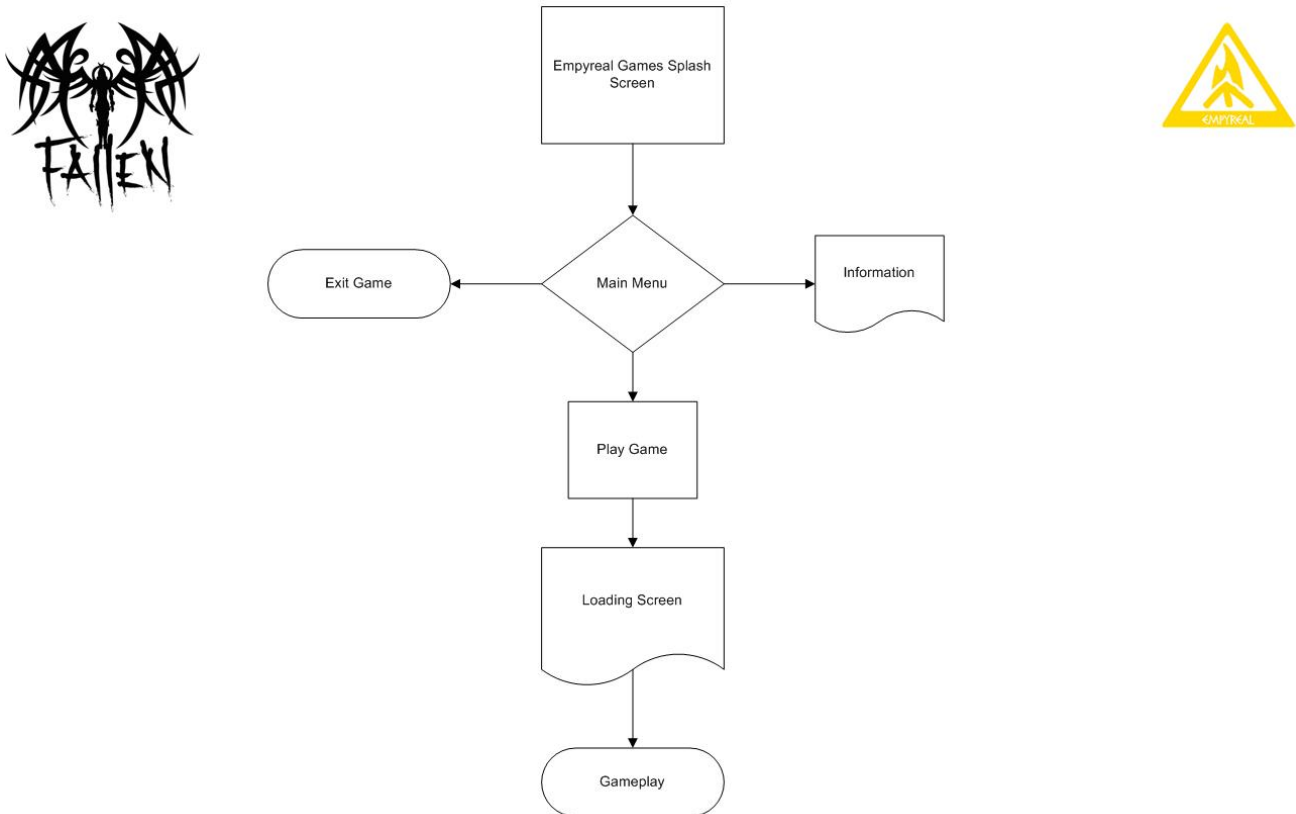
FRONT END



The front end is designed in Flash and will launch the game from a separate window. Within this menu the user can access 3 buttons:

- Play Game
- Information
 - Describes and details controls, different spells/abilities and the credits.
- Exit Game

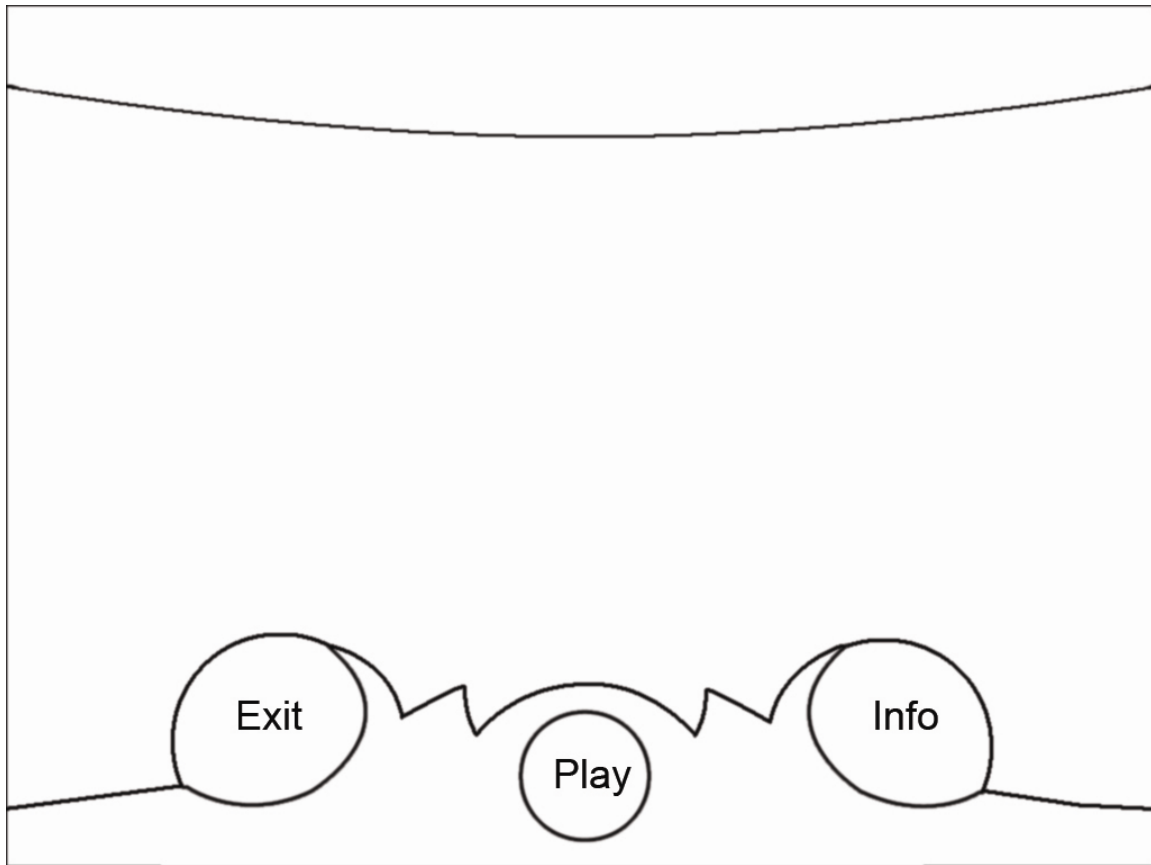
SCREEN FLOW DIAGRAMS



This is the screen flow diagram for the Fallen front end.



WIREFRAME



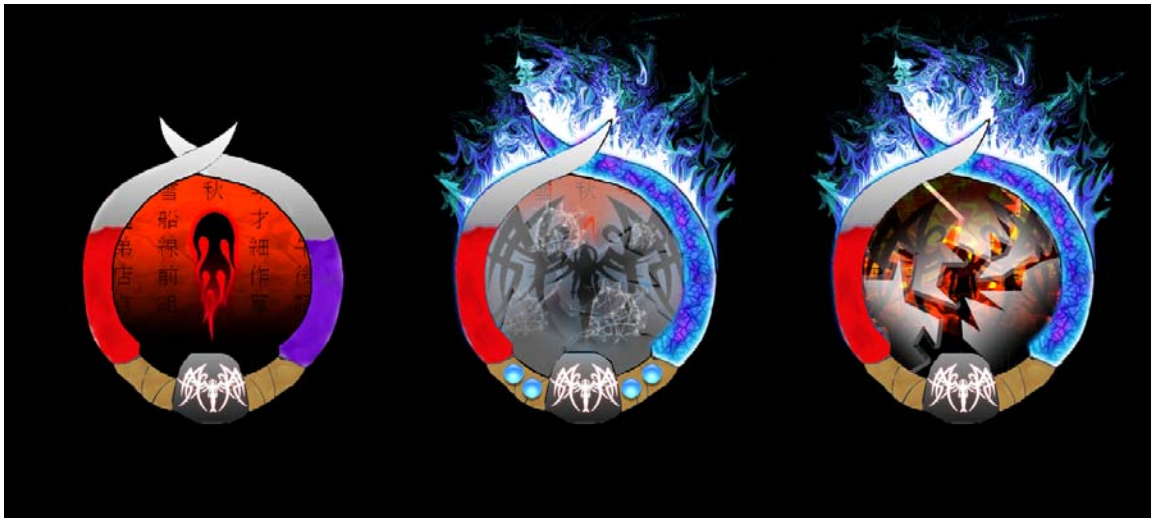
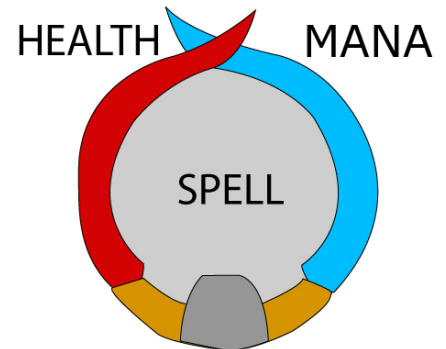
As the front end is based in Flash, it is possible to include animated buttons, complex sounds and video playback. Each button animates like a soul gem would when clicked on, swirling inside. In the background a video trailer of Fallen plays, showing footage from in-game and cut scenes.



FALLEN HUD

The HUD within Fallen is designed to be fairly minimalist. It should not intrude on the player experience or at all disconnect the player from the world which they are exploring and existing within. The HUD is purely a tool of communication that clarifies the following:

- Currently selected spell
- Health
- Souls



HUD Concept

Shown above are 3 stages of the same HUD. While in caster form the HUD clearly and simply shows health, souls and the current spell selected (Fireball). When the player switches into Demon Form, the HUD similarly reflects the change, in this case it shatters and sets alight.



SCORE AND SOUND FX



OVERVIEW

As audio is such a major feature for Fallen, it is key that objectives are set for its development. Audio for Fallen is built with the following objectives:

- Immersion
- Quality

As a result, audio must be realistic to the setting, clear to the player, accurate to the dark, serious theme and properly placed within the game. There are 3 key aspects to Fallen's audio – Voice over dialogue, SFX and Music.

To satisfy quality, any audio assets must also meet the technical limits of the Unreal 2004 engine. Details regarding technical aspects are noted in the audio document.

SOUND DESIGN

Dialogue

Dialogue within Fallen almost all occurs within the player's "mind". This is the component that drives immersion and therefore must also be given the most time and effort. Voice acting is used with scripted material and an emphasis on accurate acting to communicate the serious tone of the game. Dialogue is also the only story tool as very little machinima cut scenes are used. As a result, it is vital that dialogue meets or exceeds the objectives set above.

SFX

Fallen has a broad variety of weapons and a unique world, Fallen SFX covers a broad range of sound styles. Each spell has a variety of sounds, eg. Fireball (Cast > Travel Sound > Detonate > After Effect). Furthermore to immerse the player into the world of Fallen and the city of Aastille the ambience is also hugely important, especially to convince the player that they are pressured in a city that wants them dead.

Music

Music within Fallen covers two separate genres. Just as the game is an action/adventure hybrid, the music follows suit – but with rock/orchestral. Orchestral music is used to set the theme of adventure and is played as the player progresses through the different zones of Aastille. However when the player switches to Demon Form or encounters large groups of enemies in an intense battle, the music switches to rock themes to mimic the action occurring on screen.



COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS



Fallen is a hybrid game it has similar elements from many games, but none of them are directly comparable in the total feature set that they employ. The most similar to Fallen is Elder Scrolls because it has both first person and third person cameras (although the third person isn't designed to enable fast-paced combat). More recently, games have started to be released with similar themes (The Darkness, Infernal), while this is unfortunate we have evaluated the strengths and weaknesses of those games and tried to improve or build upon them.

Title	Features in common	Features Fallen has
God of War II	- Similar theme and art style (Overthrowing of gods, ancient civilization) - More abilities via more kills "Rage Of Titans" vs. "Demon Form"	- FPS/TPS variety - More arcane theme - Caster form – Ranged FPS style
Elder Scrolls: Oblivion	- FPS with magic and melee - In-depth story - Ancient theme - Magic/Physics combat sequences	- Audio driven story - Demon form – Fast paced melee TPS
Kain: Soul Reaver	'Soul' theme - Change forms with souls gathered - Melee attacks	- FPS/TPS variety - Magic/Melee hybrid - Caster form – Ranged FPS style
Dark Messiah Of Might & Magic	- FPS with magic and melee - In-depth story - Magic/Physics combat sequences	- FPS/TPS variety - Demon form – Fast paced melee TPS
Infernal	- Evil voice in your head - Demons vs. Angels theme - Absorbing the souls of fallen enemies	- Ancient/arcane setting - More fluid soul consumption (no pause to absorb) - Melee combat
The Darkness	- Similar Theme: Demon Possession - Audible Demon voice in head - Diverse gameplay [guns + demon] - Summoning hell creatures - A dark story	- Ancient setting - A good character possessed by a 'bad' character - Spells instead of guns - Third-Person
Deus Ex I/II	- In-depth story - Unique player experience – specialize in different style of attacks - FPS action	- Audio driven story - FPS/TPS variety - Demon form - Fast paced melee TPS
Halo I/II/III	- Voice in head (Cortana) - FPS action - Ranged with melee elements	- FPS/TPS variety - Demon Form - Fast paced melee TPS - Ancient mystical setting